NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA

TWO ALLIED SCHOOLS → SIXTEEN TOPICS AND TWELVE KNOWABLES → SEVEN CATEGORIES → UNIVERSAL AND PARTICULARITY → INHERENCE VERSUS CONJUNCTION → ABSENCE → PERCEPTION → CONTACTS AND EXTRAORDINARY PERCEPTION → INFERENCE → CONCOMITANCE AND FALLACIES → TESTIMONY AND VALIDITY → ERROR, SELF AND RELEASE → GOD, CAUSATION AND ATOMISM → GRADED VERDICT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final synthesis. Each card uses a layout chosen for its own content; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW
● SUBORDINATE EXTRA
● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 TWO ALLIED SCHOOLS, ONE REALISM, ONE LIBERATION PROMISE

NYĀYA = SCIENCE OF VALID KNOWING
VAIŚEṢIKA = INVENTORY OF BEING
16 TOPICS OF INQUIRY
7 CATEGORIES OF BEING
SIMILAR SYSTEMS (SAMĀNATANTRA)
NYĀYA 4 INSTRUMENTS · VAIŚEṢIKA 2
THEISM IS LATER, NOT KAṆĀDA
LOGIC AS A PATH TO RELEASE

NYĀYA (Gautama) -> valid knowing, inference, debate, fallacy, error, theology

VAIŚEṢIKA (Kaṇāda) -> substance, quality, motion, universal, particularity, inherence, absence, atomism → **LATER SYNTHESIS -> Navya-Nyāya refinement through Gaṅgeśa**

SYLLABUS ITEM 15, VERBATIM

- Nyaya—Vaiesesika : Theory of Categories; Theory of Appearance; Theory of Pramana; Self, Liberation; God; Proofs for the Existence of God; Theory of Causation; Atomistic Theory of Creation.
- The printed misspelling is retained; the normalised form is Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika.

THE LIBERATION LADDER THAT MAKES IT ONE SYSTEM

- True knowledge of reality (tattva-jñāna) removes false notion (mithyā-jñāna).
- Removing false notion stops the defects: attachment, aversion, delusion.
- Defects stopped -> activity stops -> birth stops -> suffering stops -> release (apavarga).

COUNTS AND HISTORICAL CONTROLS

- Classical Nyāya accepts four means of valid knowledge; classical Vaiśeṣika accepts two and reduces comparison and testimony to inference.
- Historically two allied systems, doctrinally fused later — not identical from the start.
- The developed creator-God apparatus belongs to Praśastapāda, Śrīdhara and Udayana, not unambiguously to Kaṇāda.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Nyāya supplies the instruments of proof and Vaiśeṣika supplies the inventory of being, and the mature system exists because neither half is usable alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika is the only Indian system that makes logic itself a path to liberation, because it holds that suffering persists through misdescription of the world.

01

STAGE 01 SIXTEEN TOPICS OF INQUIRY AND TWELVE KNOWABLES

APPARATUS: PRAMĀṆA + PRAMEYA
DOUBT TO ASCERTAINMENT
VĀDA · JALPA · VITAṆḌĀ
FOUR MODES OF FAILURE
TARKA IS AN AID, NEVER AN INSTRUMENT
JĀTI HERE = FUTILE REJOINDER
TWELVE KNOWABLES = SOTERIOLOGY

BLOCK I apparatus -> BLOCK II running an inquiry -> BLOCK III styles of dispute -> BLOCK IV modes of failure

Topic 2 opens into twelve knowables running from the self to release

THE SIXTEEN IN FOUR FUNCTIONAL BLOCKS

- Apparatus: means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa); objects of valid knowledge (prameya).
- Running an inquiry: doubt (saṃśaya), purpose (prayojana), accepted example (dṛṣṭānta), established doctrine (siddhānta), members (avayava), hypothetical reasoning (tarka), ascertainment (nirṇaya).
- Styles of dispute: truth-directed debate (vāda), victory-directed wrangling (jalpa), destructive cavil (vitaṇḍā).
- Modes of failure: fallacious reason (hetvābhāsa), quibble (chala), futile rejoinder (jāti), ground of defeat (nigrahasthāna).

TWELVE OBJECTS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE

- Self, body, senses, sense-objects, cognition, sensory mind, activity, defects, rebirth, experienced fruit, suffering, release.
- This is a soteriological sequence, not an exhaustive ontology; the Vaiśeṣika categories fall within this field while keeping their own ownership.

TWO CONTROLS THAT PROTECT THE ANSWER

- Never merge the sixteen topics of inquiry with the seven categories of being.
- Hypothetical reasoning (tarka) is an aid to the instruments (pramāṇa-anugrāhaka); its unacceptable-consequence forms are self-dependence, mutual dependence, circularity, infinite regress and contradiction of perception or inference.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The presence of quibble and the ground of defeat in the list proves that the sixteen describe disputation rather than being.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya's sixteen categories are a map of what a disciplined inquiry contains, which is why doubt, debate and defeat sit beside the instruments of proof.

02

STAGE 02 SEVEN CATEGORIES: SUBSTANCE, QUALITY AND MOTION

PADĀRTHA = NAMEABLE AND KNOWABLE
NINE SUBSTANCES
TWENTY-FOUR QUALITIES
FIVE MOTIONS
ETHER, TIME, DIRECTION ARE SUBSTANCES
KARMA HERE = PHYSICAL MOTION
MOTION MAKES CONJUNCTION

CATEGORY	WHAT IT IS	WHY IT IS ADMITTED
substance (dravya)	locus of qualities and actions	qualities and motions cannot float free
quality (guṇa)	dependent feature of a substance	substances need distinguishing features
motion (karma)	physical movement in a substance	change of relation is neither thing nor feature
universal (sāmānya)	real one-in-many	classification needs an objective ground
particularity (viśeṣa)	ultimate individuator of eternals	exactly similar eternals would collapse into one
inherence (samavāya)	eternal inseparable relation	whole–part and quality–substance ties need explaining
absence (abhāva)	structured non-existence	negative judgements have determinate content

NINE SUBSTANCES, SORTED BY THE TESTS EXAMINERS USE

- Atomic and world-building: earth, water, fire, air.
- All-pervading, eternal and non-atomic: ether (substrate of sound), time, direction.
- Knower and instrument: self — eternal, all-pervading and many; mind — eternal and atomic, one per self, so attention is serial.

TWENTY-FOUR QUALITIES AND THE POINT THEY MAKE

- Colour, taste, smell, touch, number, magnitude, distinctness, conjunction, disjunction, priority, posteriority, cognition, pleasure, pain, desire, aversion, effort, heaviness, fluidity, viscidity, dispositional tendency, merit, demerit and sound.
- Cognition, pleasure, desire, merit and demerit are qualities of the self, not its essence — the seed of the whole account of the self.

FIVE MOTIONS AND THE CAUSAL BRIDGE

- Upward, downward, contraction, expansion and locomotion.
- Motion produces conjunction and disjunction, and the non-inherent cause of an effect is typically a conjunction in the material cause.

COUNT CAUTION

- Kaṇāda's older enumeration is commonly taken as six categories, with absence added later as the seventh.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each of the seven is admitted only because a describable feature of experience would otherwise remain unexplained.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Vaiśeṣika's category list is disciplined economy rather than metaphysical extravagance, since every slot answers a distinct explanatory demand.

03

STAGE 03 THE ONE AND THE MANY: UNIVERSAL, SIX BLOCKERS, PARTICULARITY

UNIVERSAL = REAL ONE-IN-MANY
PRESENT BY INHERENCE, NOT DIVISION
SIX BLOCKERS REFUSE CANDIDATES
BLOCKED -> IMPOSED PROPERTY (UPĀDHI)
BUDDHIST EXCLUSION (APOHA)
PARTICULARITY: ETERNALS ONLY
SELF-DIFFERENTIATING = A TERMINUS

WHY THE UNIVERSAL IS ADMITTED

- Dissimilar individuals are genuinely classified together, and resemblance is always resemblance in some objectively common respect.
- It is present in many by inherence rather than by spatial division, which answers the "how can one be wholly in many?" objection.
- Buddhist exclusion theory replies that "cow" means "not non-cow"; Nyāya answers that exclusion presupposes stable exclusion-classes.

SIX BLOCKERS OF UNIVERSALHOOD — THE SCHOOL'S OWN ECONOMY

- No single instance: ether-ness is blocked if there is only one ether.
- Co-extensiveness: pot-ness and jar-ness over one class give no ground for two.
- Cross-cutting: elemental-ness and corporeal-ness must be nested or disjoint.
- Infinite regress: universal-ness over universals is blocked.
- Form-loss: a universal inside particularities would defeat individuation.
- No available relation: inherence-ness has no further inherence to attach by.

ULTIMATE PARTICULARITY AND ITS TWO OBJECTIONS

- It individuates eternal substances only — atoms of the four elements plus ether, time, direction, self and mind; composites need none.
- Regress of differentiators is answered by self-differentiation, and the imperceptibility charge by an inferential posit, since Nyāya reduces postulation to inference.
- Both replies name the stopping point rather than proving it, which is why Śrīharṣa attacks Nyāya definitions systematically.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The six blockers convert realism about universals from indiscriminate multiplication into a regulated ontology with published refusal rules.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Vaiśeṣika is the only Indian realism that publishes six conditions under which a proposed universal must be refused rather than admitted.

04

STAGE 04 INHERENCE VERSUS CONJUNCTION: THE TABLE TEST

INHERENCE IS A CATEGORY
CONJUNCTION IS A QUALITY
CRITERION = INSEPARABILITY
NOT CLOSENESS, NOT GRIP
FIVE INHERENCE PAIRS
SELF-LINKING RELATION STOPS REGRESS
NECESSARY BUT NOT SUFFICIENT

THE FIVE STANDARD INHERENCE PAIRS

- Whole and parts; quality and substance; motion and substance; universal and particular; ultimate particularity and its eternal substance.

THE 2021 QUESTION: NECESSARY OR SUFFICIENT?

- Inseparability is necessary, since every case of inherence exhibits it.
- It is not by itself sufficient: alone it is too wide (ativyāpti) as a defining characteristic, and a defining characteristic must avoid being too narrow, too wide or impossible.
- The safe formula adds the specific ontological dependence of the dependent term on its locus.

REGRESS, PARSIMONY AND THE RESIDUE

- If a relation must be related to its relata, regress follows; Nyāya answers that inherence is a self-linking relation (svarūpa-sambandha).
- Inherence is one and eternal for parsimony, so it must borrow all its specificity from its relata.
- The strongest argument for inherence is that conjunction is itself a quality and must inhere, so conjunction presupposes inherence.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Conjunction is a quality and must therefore itself inhere, which is why contact can never replace inherence in the category scheme.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The difference between a book resting on a table and its brownness is a difference of ontological kind, not of degree of attachment.

05

STAGE 05 ABSENCE: FOUR KINDS AND HOW A NEGATIVE FACT IS KNOWN

LOCUS + COUNTERPOSITIVE
PRIOR ENDS AT PRODUCTION
POSTERIOR BEGINS AT DESTRUCTION
ABSOLUTE: NEITHER BOUND
MUTUAL = DIFFERENCE
SIXTH CONTACT PERCEIVES ABSENCE
NON-COGNITION IS BHĀṬṬA, NOT NYĀYA

KIND	TEMPORAL SIGNATURE	STANDARD CASE
prior (prāgabhāva)	no beginning, has an end	the pot before it is made
posterior (pradhvaṃsābhāva)	has a beginning, no end	the pot after it is broken
absolute (atyantābhāva)	neither beginning nor end	a hare's horn
mutual (anyonyābhāva)	not temporal at all	"a pot is not a cloth"

THE 2023 STATEMENT, DECODED IN TWO CLAUSES

- "Negation always has a counterpositive" asserts that every negative cognition is directed at a determinate positive term.
- "Absolute negation is an impossibility" denies contentless negation, and does not deny absolute absence, which is an admitted kind.

THE 2024 DISCRIMINATION

- "Air does not have heat": the counterpositive is a quality, so the claim denies a qualification — absolute absence.
- "Air is not fire": the counterpositive is another substance, so the claim denies an identity — mutual absence.
- The deciding test is what the counterpositive is, not what the locus is.

THREE POSITIONS ON HOW ABSENCE IS KNOWN

- Nyāya perceives it through the qualifier–qualified relation, given four conditions: the object would be perceptible, the locus is available, the senses are competent, nothing obstructs.
- The Buddhist admits no separate negative entity and explains the judgement by non-apprehension, conceptual exclusion or inference.
- Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā admits non-cognition (anupalabdhi) as an independent instrument, which Nyāya refuses.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Absence is admitted as one category with four kinds and is known by existing instruments, so the seventh category costs no new epistemology.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Vaiśeṣika treats absence as a structured feature of the world with a locus and a counterpositive rather than as a merely linguistic operation.

06

STAGE 06 PERCEPTION: GAUTAMA'S DEFINITION AS FOUR EXCLUSION GATES

PRODUCED FROM SENSE–OBJECT CONTACT
NON-VERBAL EXCLUDES TESTIMONY
NON-ERRANT EXCLUDES ILLUSION
DETERMINATE EXCLUDES DOUBT
INDETERMINATE -> DETERMINATE
NYĀYA 4 · VAIŚEṢIKA 2
DETERMINACY CLAUSE IS CONTESTED

GATE 1 produced from sense–object contact -> excludes inference, memory, testimony → **GATE 2 non-verbal (avyapadeśya) -> excludes testimony** → **GATE 3 non-errant (avyabhicāri) -> excludes illusion and creates the debt the theory of error must pay** → **GATE 4 determinate (vyavasāyātmaka) -> excludes doubt**

THE FOUR INSTRUMENTS AND WHAT NYĀYA REDUCES

- Perception, inference, comparison and testimony; classical Vaiśeṣika keeps two and folds comparison and testimony into inference.
- Postulation (arthāpatti) is reduced to inference and non-cognition (anupalabdhi) to perception or inference — the school's characteristic move.
- Memory is excluded for lack of novelty; hypothetical reasoning is an aid, not an instrument.

INDETERMINATE AND DETERMINATE PERCEPTION

- The indeterminate phase is pre-predicative; the determinate phase is qualified and nameable, as in "this is a blue pot".
- The determinate phase is where the universal appears as qualifier, which is the epistemology behind realism about kinds.

THE TENSION THE TRADITION ITSELF FACED

- If perception must be determinate, how can the admitted indeterminate phase be perception?
- The standard reading is that the clause excludes doubt rather than the pre-predicative stage; critics answer that one word is doing two jobs.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each clause of the definition rules out one specific rival, so the definition is a filter rather than a description.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Gautama defines perception by exclusion, and the mark is earned by naming what each clause throws out rather than by translating it.

07

STAGE 07 SIX CONTACTS AND THREE EXTRAORDINARY PERCEPTIONS

EACH CONTACT REACHES ONE OBJECT
CONJUNCTION -> A SUBSTANCE
INHERENCE CHAINS -> UNIVERSALS
QUALIFIER–QUALIFIED -> ABSENCE
UNIVERSAL-MEDIATED SOLVES INDUCTION
COGNITION-MEDIATED EXPLAINS ERROR
AD HOC CHARGE REMAINS OPEN

contact 1 substance -> 2 its quality -> 3 the universal in that quality

contact 4 sound -> 5 sound-ness -> 6 absence → **ordinary contact reaches this world; extraordinary perception reaches the kind, the remembered and the remote**

THE SIX SENSE–OBJECT CONTACTS

- Conjunction reaches a substance such as the pot.
- Inherence in what is conjoined reaches its quality or motion.
- Inherence in what inheres in what is conjoined reaches the universal in that quality.
- Inherence reaches sound; inherence in what inheres reaches sound-ness.
- The qualifier–qualified relation reaches absence, such as jar-absence qualifying a table.

THREE EXTRAORDINARY PERCEPTIONS, TWO LOAD-BEARING

- Universal-mediated perception relates the knower to smoke as such on perceiving an instance of smokeness — the specifically Nyāya answer to induction.
- Cognition-mediated perception lets a prior cognition mediate a present presentation, which is the mechanism of the theory of error.
- Yogic perception reaches subtle, distant, past or future objects.

THE 2023 EVALUATIVE VERDICT

- For: determinate perception presents the object as qualified by a universal, and contacts three and five exist to reach universals.
- Against: universal-mediated perception may be an ad hoc device for induction, and exclusion theory explains classification without a perceived one-in-many.
- Verdict: justified within Nyāya's realist ontology, not for an opponent who has already refused it.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Two of the three extraordinary perceptions are load-bearing, since one carries the theory of induction and the other the theory of error.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya multiplies contacts rather than instruments, so that qualities, universals and absences become perceptible without a new means of valid knowledge.

08

STAGE 08 INFERENCE: FIVE MEMBERS, THREE GRIDS, FIVE MARKS

SUBJECT · PROPERTY · REASON
EXAMPLE HAS NO WESTERN COUNTERPART
SUBSUMPTIVE REFLECTION IS THE CAUSE
FOR ONESELF / FOR ANOTHER
FIVE MARKS OF A VALID REASON
ŚEṢAVAT HAS TWO READINGS
CONCOMITANCE MUST BE ALREADY KNOWN

1 thesis: the hill has fire → **2 reason: because it has smoke** → **3 example: wherever smoke, fire — as in a kitchen** → **4 application: this hill has such smoke** → **5 conclusion: therefore the hill has fire**

WHY MEMBERS THREE AND FOUR MATTER MOST

- Together they are the public form of the subsumptive reflection: "this hill possesses smoke which is pervaded by fire".
- That reflection is the immediate cause of the inferential cognition, so the demonstration is a causal-cognitive episode, not merely a valid pattern.

FIVE MARKS OF A VALID REASON

- Presence in the subject; presence in similar instances; absence from dissimilar instances; not contradicted by a stronger instrument; not counterbalanced by an equally strong counter-reason.

TWO CONTROLS

- State which of the three grids is being used, because the effect-to-cause type is also read as residual inference.
- Later Indian logicians accepted that fewer members suffice for a trained hearer, so the five-membered form is dialectically rather than logically indispensable.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The obligatory empirical example marks Nyāya's refusal to detach validity from the world the inference is about.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The five-membered demonstration is not a clumsy syllogism but a schema for producing warranted assent in another person.

09

STAGE 09 SECURING CONCOMITANCE AND THE FIVE FALLACIES

FIXED AND UNCONDITIONED
NOT MERE FREQUENCY
ADJUNCT PERVADES THE PROPERTY
WET FUEL DEFEATS FIRE-TO-SMOKE
TARKA IS AN AID, SO NO CIRCLE
FIVE MARKS READ NEGATIVELY
SCEPTIC SELF-REFUTES
REPLY NEEDS REAL UNIVERSALS

THE ADJUNCT FORMULA, WORKED

- An adjunct pervades the property to be proved but does not pervade the reason.
- In "the hill has smoke because it has fire", wet fuel pervades smoke but not fire, so fire does not unconditionally pervade smoke and the inference fails.
- Systematic elimination plus removal of the suspicion of an adjunct converts observation into warranted universal cognition.

THE CĀRVĀKA CASE AND FOUR REPLIES

- Objection: no finite observation licenses a universal, adjunct-elimination can never be completed, hypothetical reasoning is circular, and universal-mediated perception is ad hoc.
- Replies: mathematical certainty is the wrong demand; hypothetical reasoning is an aid, not a proof; universal-mediated perception is not ad hoc given real kinds; and a universal denial of inference is itself a universal claim.

WHY EXACTLY FIVE FALLACIES

- Because a valid reason is defined by five conditions, exactly five modes of failure are possible.
- Four map one-to-one onto a mark; the contradictory reason is the exception, inverting the relation all five marks presuppose.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Nyāya replaces enumeration with elimination and then grounds elimination in a realist ontology of kinds.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya's reply to the sceptic is not that induction can be made certain but that it can be made disciplined.

10

STAGE 10 WORDS AND WARRANT: COMPARISON, TESTIMONY, VALIDITY, FRUIT

COMPARISON FIXES A WORD
RELIABLE SPEAKER, THREE TESTS
FOUR SENTENCE CONDITIONS
MEMORY LACKS NOVELTY
EXTRINSIC FOR BOTH
HALF-POSITION IS THE TRAP
INSTRUMENT IS NOT ITS FRUIT

TESTIMONY IN THREE LIMBS

- A reliable person knows the matter correctly, intends to communicate it truthfully and is competent to express it; status and confidence create no authority.
- An intelligible sentence needs mutual expectancy, semantic fitness, proximity in utterance and an intended meaning, as when "saindhava" means salt at dinner and a horse before a journey.
- The result is cognition of the word–object relation, and hence of the object.

WHY VALIDITY IS EXTRINSIC BOTH WAYS

- Truth depends on whether the generating conditions were free of defect, to which the knower has no internal access.
- Confirmation therefore comes from successful activity, coherence or corroboration.
- If validity were self-certifying, illusion would be self-detecting, which the shell-silver case refutes.

CIRCULARITY GUARD ON VEDIC TESTIMONY

- Later Nyāya links Vedic authority to God as omniscient author, so the scriptural proof of God must remain a converging strand rather than the foundation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The two sets of conditions divide the risk exactly, locating failure either in the speaker or in the utterance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya's treatment of testimony is the point at which its realism becomes a social epistemology with specified conditions for legitimate dependence.

11

STAGE 11 ERROR, SELF, MIND AND RELEASE

BOTH TERMS OF THE ERROR ARE REAL
COGNITION-MEDIATED PRESENTATION
SUBLATION DENIES A LOCATION
CONSCIOUSNESS IS A QUALITY
SIX MARKS, NOT EIGHT
MIND IS ATOMIC
RELEASE = CESSATION, NOT BLISS
STONE-LIKE OBJECTION SURVIVES

real shell present; real silver elsewhere → **glitter revives a past impression of silver** → **cognition-mediated perception makes the silver present without physical presence** → **non-discrimination permits the wrong synthesis** → **"this is silver" — the false cognition**

sublation: "this is not silver", denying the relation and not an entity

FIVE THEORIES OF ERROR BY ONTOLOGICAL COST

- Prābhākara non-apprehension of difference: no false cognition at all.
- Nyāya misplacement: two reals, one bad relation.
- Yogācāra self-apprehension: an inner cognition projected outward.
- Advaita the indefinable: neither real nor unreal.
- Mādhyamika apprehension of the non-existent, in standard doxography.

THE SELF AND ITS SIX MARKS

- Desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain and cognition are the marks; the sixth is structurally different, since cognition is a quality needing a substance.
- Memory, recognition and the instrument-user argument are supplementary and must never be substituted when six reasons are asked.
- The self is eternal, all-pervading and many; the mind is atomic, so attention is serial and deep sleep leaves the self uncognising.

RELEASE AND ITS COST

- Release is absolute cessation of pain, not the acquisition of bliss.
- Bliss would be relational and could generate attachment, so a state of bliss would not be secure.
- The reply is coherent, but a motivational cost survives: a goal no one can desire as a state remains hard to recommend.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The form of the corrective cognition is the decisive evidence, since a correction that denies location shows that only the placing was false.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya's theory of error is the strongest test of its realism, because falsity is relocated from the objects into the relation asserted between them.

12

STAGE 12 GOD, CAUSATION AND ATOMISM

EFFICIENT CAUSE ONLY
ATOMS ARE THE MATERIAL CAUSE
CUMULATIVE, NOT ONE PROOF
EFFECT IS NEWLY PRODUCED
ANYATHĀSIDDHA EXCLUDES THE REST
THREE DYADS MAKE A TRIAD
EVIL ANSWERED BY KARMA
YOGA'S GOD IS NOT PROVED THIS WAY

PROOF	REASON OFFERED	RESIDUAL PRESSURE
from effect (kāryāt)	the world is composite and ordered, hence an effect	the pot–potter analogy is strained because makers are embodied
from combination (āyojanāt)	inert atoms cannot start ordered first motion	the opponent may call ordered initiation brute rather than intelligent
from sustenance (dhṛtyādeḥ)	the cosmos is maintained, regulated and dissolved	regulation may be explained without a regulator
from scripture (śruteḥ)	Vedic scope exceeds ordinary knowledge	if the Veda is authorless, the strand loses force
moral administration	unconscious karma cannot allot fruits precisely	divine independence is limited by a karmic order God did not make

THE DEFINITION OF CAUSE AND ITS FILTER

- A cause is an unconditional and invariable antecedent that is not otherwise established; the complete cause is the causal complex plus the absence of a blocker.
- Five otherwise-established antecedents are excluded: the colour of the potter's staff, the potter's father, the sound of the staff, all-pervading space and the potter's donkey.
- Three kinds of cause — inherent threads, their non-inherent conjunction and the efficient weaver — mirror substance, quality and agency.

PRIOR NON-EXISTENCE AGAINST SĀṂKHYA

- Prior non-existence has no beginning but ends exactly at production, so its termination and the effect's origination are one event.
- A real absence cannot coexist with a latent presence, so the effect is genuinely absent before production.
- The argument is decisive inside an ontology that admits absences and question-begging outside it.

NYĀYA AND YOGA DO NOT PROVE GOD THE SAME WAY

- Nyāya infers God as the explanation of cosmic and moral order.
- Classical Yoga admits a special conscious witness untouched by afflictions, actions, fruits and deposits, whose role is practical: devotion aids meditative absorption.
- Sameness of name is not sameness of demonstration or function.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The atomism's own gap — inert atoms plus an unconscious moral ledger — is what makes the school theistic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Udayana's achievement is a converging case in which each strand can be resisted alone yet together they leave one explanatory hypothesis standing.

13

STAGE 13 VERDICT, CROSS-SCHOOL GRID AND THE ANSWER RAIL

THREE STIPULATED TERMINI
STRONG: INFERENCE AND THEOLOGY
WEAK: TERMINI AND UNCONSCIOUS RELEASE
CONTESTED: PERCEPTION OF KINDS
CLOSE WITH STRENGTH + COST
MATCH THE CLOSE TO THE DIRECTIVE
DISPUTES ARE ABOUT STARTING-POINTS

name the half of the system -> define technically -> give the argument with named evidence -> add one named opponent and reply -> close with strength, cost and condition

THE THREE STIPULATED TERMINI

- Inherence is declared self-linking; ultimate particularity is declared self-differentiating; the universal is declared perceptually given.
- All serious criticism converges on exactly these three and not on random points.

GRADED VERDICT

- Strong: the most developed Indian theory of inference and fallacy, a serious realist reply to inductive scepticism, a regulated ontology and a cumulative natural theology.
- Weak: the three termini, release without consciousness, God limited by beginningless karma, and apparent proliferation of categories.
- Contested: whether universal-mediated perception is genuine perception, whether this is one system or two, and whether an embodied-artisan analogy can prove a bodiless maker.

CLOSING LINES BY MARK

- Ten marks: strongest as a realist logic-ontology, but its primitive relations and particularisers remain vulnerable.
- Fifteen marks: the instruments secure knowledge, the categories secure being and God secures order, yet inherence, particularity and unconscious release are asserted as much as proved.
- Twenty marks: the very devices that make the system complete are also its deepest contested points.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Stopping a regress is not itself a fault, but Nyāya stops selectively, using regress against opponents while claiming immunity for its own termini.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A fair verdict is necessarily graded, because the devices that complete the system and the devices that expose it are the same devices.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

NAVYA-NYĀYA PRECISION
INHERENCE AS A STRESS TEST
PARTICULARITY AS BARE THINNESS
UDAYANA AS CUMULATIVE THEIST
ONE LINE, TWO AT MOST

FOUR OPTIONAL MODULES

- Navya-Nyāya technicality is a response to Śrīharṣa's definitional pressure rather than an ornament.
- Inherence is a relation-theory stress test: sui generis, or merely a name for the problem of relation?
- Ultimate particularity functions as a primitive thisness, which is why it is simultaneously complete and contestable.
- Udayana is best read as a cumulative rational theist rather than as offering four independent demonstrations.

CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISONS

- Concomitance and Hume: both see that regularity does not entail necessity, but Nyāya claims warranted universal cognition because kinds are real.
- Inherence and Bradley: both see a regress of relations, but Nyāya stops it by self-linking rather than by denying relations.
- Udayana and design arguments: Nyāya's God is efficient cause only, working with eternal atoms and eternal karma.

WHAT NOT TO OVER-STUDY

- Full Navya symbolising habits, endless later sub-fallacies, exhaustive subtypes of quibble or ground of defeat, and every later theistic proof variant.

OPTIONAL STATUS — Everything in this subordinate stage is unnecessary for a competent core answer and repairs no gap in the core spine.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels